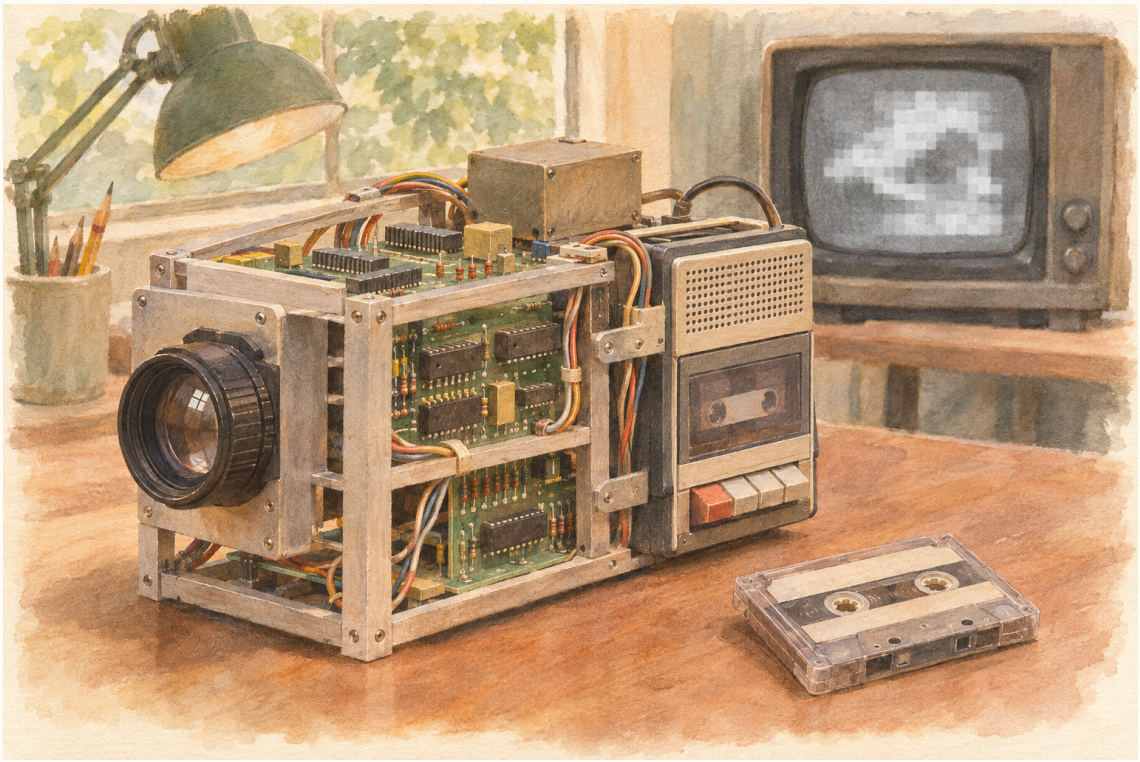
发明了数码相机，却被它打败

The Company That Invented Its Own Killer



造出数码相机的公司，为什么仍被数码时代冲击？

英文原文

In 1975 Kodak engineer Steven Sasson built the first **digital camera**. The **toaster**-sized **gadget**, a **cumbersome heavyweight** of about eight pounds, was hardly **portable**, **let alone handheld**. Its first **rudimentary** picture held 10,000 black-and-white **pixels**. Recording it on a **cassette** took 23 seconds, and a **playback** unit showed it on a television.

Kodak's **revenues** showed its **dependence on** film, the **profitable pillar** of its business. Technical **staffers** were **appreciative of** the camera, but it needed no film. By Sasson's **recollection**, his **superiors** at **headquarters** called it cute and urged him to **keep it hushed**. A **patent** followed in 1978. Production never did.

The **advent** of digital photography proved **disruptive**. In June 2009 Kodak said it would stop making Kodachrome, its **analogue** film, citing **lessened** demand in the digital **era**. Kodak's **manpower** had reached an **apex** of about 145,000 in the 1980s. By 2012, **layoffs** since 2003 had **slashed** 47,000 jobs, alongside the **shutdown** of 13 factories and some 130 labs.

On 19 January 2012 the 131-year-old firm sought Chapter 11 protection from its **creditors**, **sapped** by **pension** costs and years of **slowness** in going digital. Citigroup, a **lender**, provided $950 million for its **restructuring**. A **portfolio** of 1,100 digital imaging patents fetched about $525 million from a **consortium** of twelve **buyers**, including the **giants** Apple and Google.

After 19 months of **reorganisation**, the **once-mighty** Kodak left bankruptcy in September 2013, **downsized**, **streamlined**, and **refocused as** a commercial **printer** for business **clients**. In November 2009 President Obama had **decorated** Sasson with national **laurels**, **commending** his digital camera. That **medal**'s year also saw Kodak announce **the end of** Kodachrome.

中文译文

1975年，柯达工程师史蒂文·萨松造出了第一台数码相机。这台烤面包机大小的小器械/小装置，是个笨重的大块头，重约八磅，很难说是便携的，更谈不上手持。它拍下的第一张粗糙的照片，只有1万个黑白像素。把照片录到盒式磁带上要花23秒，再由一台回放装置在电视上显示出来。

柯达的收入显示出公司对胶卷的依赖，胶卷是其业务中赚钱的支柱。技术员工对这台相机颇为赞赏，但它不需要胶卷。据萨松回忆，他在总部的上司说它挺可爱，并敦促他对此秘而不宣。1978年，这台相机获得专利，生产部门却从未这样做过（跟进）。

数码摄影的问世，结果证明是颠覆性的。2009年6月，柯达宣布将停产Kodachrome这种模拟胶卷，理由是数码时代里需求减少。柯达的员工规模曾达到约14.5万人的顶峰，那是在20世纪80年代。到2012年，自2003年以来的裁员已砍掉4.7万个岗位，同时13家工厂和约130个冲印室相继关闭。

2012年1月19日，这家已有131年历史的公司申请《破产法》第11章保护，以免受债权人追讨，它受养老金负担和多年来转向数码的迟缓所慢慢抽空/消耗。贷款方（借出钱的人）花旗集团提供了9.5亿美元，用于其重组。由1,100项数字成像专利构成的组合以约5.25亿美元卖给一个由十二家买家组成的财团，其中包括巨头苹果和谷歌。

经过19个月的改组，昔日强大的柯达于2013年9月走出破产，规模已缩小，业务经过精简，重新定位为商业印刷商，面向企业客户。2009年11月，奥巴马总统授予萨松国家级荣誉，来表彰他的数码相机。那枚奖章颁发的同年，柯达也宣布了Kodachrome 的终结。

词汇与表达

digital camera n.
数码相机

toaster n.
烤面包机

gadget n.
小器械/小装置

cumbersome adj.
笨重的
a cumbersome heavyweight

heavyweight n.
大块头

portable adj.
便携的

let alone conj.
更谈不上

handheld adj.
手持

rudimentary adj.
粗糙的
Its first rudimentary picture

pixels n.
像素

cassette n.
盒式磁带

playback n.
回放

revenues n.
收入
Kodak's revenues

dependence on n.
对……依赖
its dependence on film

profitable adj.
赚钱的
the profitable pillar of its business

pillar n.
支柱

staffers n.
员工

appreciative of adj.
赞赏
appreciative of the camera

recollection n.
回忆
By Sasson's recollection

superiors n.
上司

headquarters n.
总部

keep it hushed adj.
秘而不宣
urged him to keep it hushed

patent n.
专利
A patent followed in 1978

advent n.
问世
The advent of digital photography

disruptive adj.
颠覆性的
proved disruptive

analogue adj.
模拟

lessened adj.
减少

词汇与表达（续）

era n.
时代

manpower n.
员工规模

apex n.
顶峰

layoffs n.
裁员
layoffs since 2003

slashed v.
砍掉

shutdown n.
关闭

creditors n.
债权人
protection from its creditors

sapped v.
慢慢抽空/消耗
sapped by pension costs

pension n.
养老金

slowness n.
迟缓

lender n.
贷款方（借出钱的人）

restructuring n.
重组
for its restructuring

portfolio n.
组合
A portfolio of 1,100

consortium n.
财团
a consortium of twelve buyers

buyers n.
买家

giants n.
巨头

reorganisation n.
改组
19 months of reorganisation

once-mighty adj.
昔日强大的

downsized adj.
缩小
downsized, streamlined

streamlined adj.
精简
downsized, streamlined

refocused as v.
重新定位为
refocused as a commercial printer

printer n.
印刷商

clients n.
客户

decorated v.
授予

laurels n.
荣誉

commending v.
表彰
commending his digital camera

medal n.
奖章

the end of n.
终结

文章简述

- 先机：1975年，柯达工程师萨松造出第一台数码相机：约八磅重、一万黑白像素，存一张照片需23秒。
- 牵制：胶卷是利润支柱；据萨松回忆，上司让他别声张。原型机1978年获专利，却未投产。
- 衰退：数码摄影冲击胶卷需求，转型迟缓与养老金负担削弱公司，柯达于2012年申请破产保护。
- 重组：柯达获9.5亿美元贷款，并以约5.25亿美元出售1100项专利；2013年完成重组，转做企业印刷。
- 反差：2009年，萨松因数码相机获美国国家荣誉；同年，柯达宣布停产Kodachrome这一胶卷产品。